

ElevenLabs

AI Voice / Conversational-Audio · New York, NY / London, UK · Private (\$11B; \$500M Series D Feb 2026; \$330M+ ARR; ICONIQ-backed)

ElevenLabs - the \$11B AI-voice leader (ICONIQ tripled down in its \$500M Series D) - has never been in motorsport, and AI voice/multilingual content is a real fan-engagement workstream for a global sport (scored WARM as a brand/content play, not performance tech).

74

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

McLaren

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

ElevenLabs, the AI-voice and conversational-audio leader, raised a \$500M Series D at an \$11B valuation in Feb 2026 (Sequoia-led, with ICONIQ tripling down and a16z; NVIDIA-backed), closed 2025 with \$330M+ ARR (Deutsche Telekom, Square, Revolut, the Ukrainian Government), and is building toward an IPO behind its ElevenAgents conversational-AI platform. It surfaced through the MD's ICONIQ-investment lens, and it has never entered motorsport. The fit with F1 is fan-and-content-led: F1's audience is global, young and multilingual, and ElevenLabs' AI dubbing, voice and conversational agents can localise and scale a team's content, social and fan experiences. HONEST framing: this is a brand/content/fan-engagement play (MODE B), not a performance or in-car workstream, so it is scored WARM, not HOT - and AI is broadly present on the grid, so the open lane is voice/audio specifically. CEO & co-founder Mati Staniszewski (with CTO Piotr Dabkowski).

WHY NOW

ElevenLabs is in a fast-scaling, pre-IPO brand-building phase (tripled valuation, \$330M+ ARR), so it has the capital and the motive to invest in a global brand stage, and F1's multilingual global audience is an on-message fit for AI voice/content. The honest 'why now' is the brand/IPO window, not a forcing F1 event.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$11B

Series D valuation (Feb 2026; \$500M round, Sequoia-led, ICONIQ tripled down, NVIDIA-backed)

\$500M

Series D round size

\$330M+

ARR at end of 2025 (Deutsche Telekom, Square, Revolut, Ukraine Gov)

Mati Staniszewski

Co-Founder & CEO

ElevenAgents

Enterprise conversational-AI platform

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

McLaren	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Aston Martin	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

The AI-voice leader - \$11B after a \$500M Series D (Feb 2026; Sequoia-led, ICONIQ tripled down, NVIDIA-backed), \$330M+ ARR, IPO-track. Surfaced via the MD's ICONIQ-investment lens. Real-ish workstream for a global, multilingual sport: AI dubbing/voice and conversational agents for fan content and engagement. HONEST: this is a fan-content/brand fit (MODE B), not performance tech, so it is scored WARM, not HOT. CEO Mati Staniszewski.

WHY MCLAREN

McLaren has one of the largest, most global and most digitally-engaged fanbases in F1 and a content-leading brand, so AI multilingual voice/content and conversational fan experiences map onto a real audience-growth need. The voice/audio lane is distinct from McLaren's enterprise-software partners; the value is fan content and engagement, not car technology.

VALUE TO MCLAREN — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B with concrete, named mechanics. (1) FAN CONTENT / LOCALISATION: ElevenLabs' AI dubbing and voice can localise the team's content, social and video across F1's many languages at scale - reaching global fans in their own language - a genuine, measurable content-and-audience workstream (not signage). (2) CONVERSATIONAL EXPERIENCES: ElevenAgents can power fan-facing conversational voice experiences (team app, driver/race Q&A, sponsor activations) - a distinctive, ownable fan product. (3) BRAND / TALENT: 'the voice of the team, in every language' is an on-message co-marketing story for an IPO-track AI brand, with an AI-engineering talent halo. McLaren gets scaled multilingual fan content and a marquee AI partner; ElevenLabs gets a global brand stage in front of a massive audience. (Scored honestly: fan-content/brand value, not performance.)

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official AI Voice / Fan-Content Partner on McLaren, minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr, centred on AI multilingual content/dubbing and conversational fan experiences (ElevenAgents) - a brand/content partnership, not a technical deployment.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Mati Staniszewski
CO-FOUNDER & CEO, ELEVENLABS - VERIFIED

Co-founder and CEO (with CTO Piotr Dabkowski) of the \$11B AI-voice leader, building toward an IPO - the owner of brand/partnership decisions at this founder-led company and the entry point. Decision path: Staniszewski (brand/strategy) with the marketing/brand leadership as activation counterpart; confirm the brand lead before outreach.

OPENING ANGLE

"Mati - F1's audience is global, young and multilingual, and no one owns the AI-voice/content lane on the grid. As you build toward IPO, 'the voice of the team in every language' on McLaren's huge fanbase is a brand stage made for ElevenLabs. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 \$500M Series D at \$11B (Feb 2026), valuation tripled in a year, \$330M+ ARR, IPO-track - capital and brand momentum are strong.	CAPACITY 17 / 20 \$11B valuation, \$500M raised, \$330M+ ARR - comfortably funds a partner tier.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 AI voice/content suits a global, multilingual fan sport, but it's a content/brand fit (not performance), and AI generally is present on the grid - so WARM, not pristine.	URGENCY 13 / 20 An IPO-track brand window and the AI-voice land-grab, but no dated F1 trigger.	OPS FIT 13 / 20 MODE B: the value is fan-facing - AI dubbing/multilingual content and conversational voice agents for the team's audience - real-ish content/media, not an in-car or performance workstream.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

CONTENT/BRAND, NOT PERFORMANCE ElevenLabs offers fan-content value, not an in-car or performance workstream. **Counter:** Scored MODE-B/WARM accordingly; pitch the measurable fan-content/localisation and conversational-experience mechanics, not a technical deal.

AI PRESENT ON THE GRID Several teams have AI partners (Anthropic, TWG, Cognition). **Counter:** Those are LLM/agent/coding AI; ElevenLabs' voice/audio is a distinct lane - position precisely on multilingual voice/content.

SPONSORSHIP APPETITE A fast-scaling pre-IPO AI company may prioritise product over sponsorship. **Counter:** Frame as a global brand-build ahead of IPO plus a measurable fan-content channel; right-size to a value-to-mid tier.

SOURCES

- <https://elevenlabs.io/blog/series-d>
- <https://techcrunch.com/2026/02/04/elevenlabs-raises-500m-from-sequoia-at-a-11-billion-valuation/>
- <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/02/04/nvidia-backed-ai-startup-elevenlabs-11-billion-valuation.html>
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mati_Staniszewski